

Skills Summary

More, Fewer, or the Same?

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Matching Pairs to Compare

Rule: Draw a line from each object in one group to **one** object in the other group. If a group has objects *left over* with no partner, that group has **more**.

Example: Row A has 6 dots and Row B has 4 dots. Pair them up — which row has more?

Step 1. Pair the rows dot for dot and look for leftovers — the leftovers are the proof.

Step 2. Four pairs form, and Row A still has two dots with no partner, so A has more: $6 > 4$.

Try it: Row A has 5 dots and Row B has 7 dots. After pairing, one row has leftovers. Write the comparison with $<$, $>$ or $=$.

check: $5 > 7$

Skill 2 — More or Fewer by Counting

Rule: Count each group. The **bigger count** means more; the **smaller count** means fewer. The count said later when counting up is the bigger one.

Example: One basket holds 7 apples, another holds 9. Which holds more?

Step 1. Compare the two counts: which number comes later when we count up?

Step 2. "... 7, 8, 9" — 9 comes later, so the basket of nine holds more: $7 < 9$.

Try it: One jar holds 8 marbles, another holds 5. Write the comparison with $<$, $>$ or $=$.

check: $8 < 5$

Skill 3 — Spotting the Same Number

Rule: Two groups have **the same** number when their counts match — even if one group is spread out, stacked, or arranged differently.

Example: A tight cluster counts to 6 and a long spread-out row also counts to 6. More, fewer, or the same?

Step 1. Ignore how much space each group takes — only the counts decide.

Step 2. Both counts are six, so the groups are the same: $6 = 6$.

Try it: A square of 4 dots and a row of 4 dots. Write the comparison with $<$, $>$ or $=$.

check: $4 = 4$

(!) Watch out: A spread-out group *looks* bigger but may not *be* bigger. Looks can trick you — counts cannot.